But sadly, Bohm didn't live to see much of this work. He died of a heart attack in the back of a London taxicab in 1992, at age seventy-four. He had survived the blacklist, he had suffered four decades of exile with dignity and integrity—and he had unequivocally proven that alternatives to Copenhagen were possible. His work put the lie to von Neumann's proof and directly prompted Bell's marvelous theorem. If John Bell was the father of the quantum revival, then surely David Bohm had been its grandfather.

Bohm's pilot-wave interpretation wasn't the only old idea dusted off as quantum foundations gained ground in the wake of the Bell experiments. Dieter Zeh also found new recognition for his work on decoherence, thanks to an unlikely source: John Wheeler. After his failure to reconcile his student Everett's work with the ideas of his mentor Bohr, Wheeler had set aside his interest in the foundations of quantum theory. But the Bell experiments, as well as long talks with Eugene Wigner, his colleague at Princeton, had brought Wheeler back to his former interest in the subject. Shortly after moving to the University of Texas in 1976, Wheeler started teaching a class on quantum measurements, and, as he had done at Princeton, he attracted a group of brilliant students—some of whom were profoundly affected by Wheeler's course. "Until I met John Wheeler in Austin, Texas, I had assumed that all of the deep questions were understood—or in any case, not an appropriate subject for a student," said Wojciech Zurek, one of Wheeler's students. "Wheeler changed that.… [In his class] we read Bohr and Einstein, but we also discussed connections between quantum theory and information, and played with ideas.… I became gradually convinced that questions about quantum mechanics, the role of the observer, and the nature of information in physics are important and largely open."

Zurek's work in Wheeler's class, along with a David Deutsch lecture he attended in Texas, got him thinking about the relationship between entanglement and measurement in quantum physics, and specifically the effects of entanglement between a quantum system and its wider environment—in other words, decoherence. Talking extensively with